

The Time Travelers Journal

written by

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During opening production logos.

The music of Swiss Boy by Lou Sern begins to play over the beginning logos and continues into the first scene.

EXT. SOUTH WEST - DESERT - DAY

A vast, desert landscape, clear blue sky, sand hills near the foreground with more mountainous regions in the back, around noon. After a few seconds, ARTHUR STERLING, a man in his late 20s wearing jeans and a dark gray denim jacket appears suddenly in the air a few feet off the ground in a horizontal position facing down, and promptly falls on his face.

ARTHUR
(groaning, sand on face)
Aw hell,.. ow

Arthur painfully stands up and wipes the sand off of him, searching for a music player on the ground. Swiss Boy becomes diegetic for a few moments before Arthur turns the music off and puts it in his pocket. After it's stored, he continues to look around for a few seconds and focuses on something a few yards away.

In the sand is a perfectly black circle, as if there's a hole in reality. A small trail beside it suggests it had rolled.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
(walking over, taking
jacket off)
There you are,

Arthur bends down carefully over the rock and cautiously puts his jacket over it, wrapping it up and being careful not to touch it. He ties the sleeves together to hold it in place and stands up slowly, tying his jacket to his belt and looking around to get a sense of his surroundings.

Arthur starts walking toward the road, beginning to follow it east, glancing around some more and sticking out his thumb to hitchhike after a few seconds.

EXT. SOUTH WEST - DINER - DAY

Arthur is dropped off by a truck in front of a small diner just off the main road, and waves goodbye to the driver as they roll away. Crossing the parking lot, he notices a 1957 red convertible chevy bel air and gives an impressed whistle

ARTHUR

You seem a bit out of time,. Like
me

He gives it a slight approving nod, before shifting his attention to the diner and eyeballs it a bit before deciding to walk inside.

CUT TO:

INT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

Arthur enters the diner, which rings a bell attached to the door, and walks up to the bar placing his hands on the counter in a slight lean, looking around for someone to talk to. He notices a small sign that reads "todays soup: chicken noodle, Friday special"

He doesn't look at it long, and gets the attention of an older woman in a yellow uniform.

DINER LADY

(dejected, walking over)
Welcome. What can i get you?

ARTHUR

Hi! I was just wondering if you had
any extra boxes i could take off
your hands? One about this big
would be ideal.

Arthur makes a general shape with his hands showing how big the box should be, but the lady doesn't look.

DINER LADY

Yeah i should. I can look in the
back

ARTHUR

Sweet, thanks!

She turns and walks through the diner doors. On the wall next to them is a simple month and day calendar that reads "July 12". Arthur pulls a small notebook from his back pocket.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

(whispering to himself)
Friday the 12th, ..

He flips through the pages of the notebook, running his finger along the pages. After a few seconds, he stops on one entry and taps it a few times.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
 (looking up, away from the
 notebook)
 1985,. That makes the most sense

Arthur closes the notebook and puts it away slowly as if lost in thought, and stares at the counter a moment before the door bell of someone entering brings him back.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
 An entire year off,.

The diner employee walks in from the back area holding a small cardboard box filled with packing peanuts

DINER LADY
 This is all I've got.

She puts the box on the counter.

DINER LADY (CONT'D)
 Will that be all?

Arthur looks around the box, inspecting it and tests its structural integrity.

ARTHUR
 Yes, thank you! This will work great.

DINER LADY
 (walking away)
 Mm hmm.

She goes to help a newly sat down pair of men in black suits and sunglasses at the other end of the bar as Arthur unravels his jacket carefully and drops the rock into the box.

The men and the waitress are talking, and she nods, then points them towards Arthur. They get up and walk toward him, while he folds the lid flaps of the box in a way so it stays closed, and breaths a sigh of relief now that its secure.

Arthur smiles a bit, puts on his jacket, picks up the box and begins to head toward the exit but isn't paying attention and walks directly into the 2 suited men.

ARTHUR
 Oh, sorry about that I wasn't-

Arthur trails off as he gets a good look at them, and they stare at each other for a second.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

Well, that was quick,

He gives a slight chuckle, and shoves the box into the face of the 2nd man, causing him to lose balance. The first man goes to grab Arthur, but he manages to dodge and clumsily jumps over the bar and falls on the other side, leaving the box on the counter.

The first man recomposes himself after the failed grab and turns to face the box with Arthur out of sight. He leans in to grab the box, when Arthur reaches up and they grab it at the same time. Now standing up, they look at each other and have a tug of war with the box over the counter and pull it across the bar knocking over dishes, and a glass of ice water.

Everyone in the diner is now watching and the 2nd man gets up from being knocked over earlier. He smoothly jumps over the counter and runs towards the struggling duo. Arthur notices and lets go of the box sending both of them falling backwards, man 1 into a booth knocking over the table and Arthur back into the rear counter knocking over a coffee pot. The 2nd man goes right past where the pair used to be and slips on the ice water that was knocked over.

Arthur grabs the coffee pot and quickly makes his way around the bar, stepping over the felled suit. Makes his way around the corner to the first man who's getting up from the fallen table, still holding the box. Arthur splashes the coffee from the pot onto the mans face, who is taken by surprise but ultimately unphased

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

(surprised)

I thought that'd be hotter,

Instead, he tosses the pot itself directly at the mans head, and he reels back, dropping the box directly into the arms of a prepared Arthur. Both men are temporarily stunned as Arthur books it out of the diner.

The waitress comes out of the kitchen and stands over the men laying on the ground

DINER LADY

You guys are cleaning this up.

EXT. DINER PARKING LOT - CONTINUOUS

Arthur runs through the lot, box in hand and speeds right past the bel air, but stops and makes his way back toward it.

He stares at it for a beat, when the DING of the diner doors alerts him, the 2 men are back up and looking for him, but have guns drawn this time. Arthur quickly ducks down behind the car and hides, the men didn't spot him.

They make their way down the lot, checking the space in between each car methodically, one at a time. Arthur shuffles along the edge of the car quietly toward the front passenger door, but stumbles and drags his foot on the asphalt, just enough to make a slight sound that the first man just barely hears.

Arthur is wide eyed and looking around for an escape route, looking at the box briefly but then shakes his head with a quick, dismissive snort, casting the idea aside. Next to the bel air is a lifted pickup, and as the men get closer, Arthur can just barely squeeze under the truck to hide as they turn the corner.

The men stare at nothing in the gap, but their facial expressions don't change. One notices a small piece of fabric poking out from under the truck and looks like he might bend down to see under the vehicle, but is interrupted by a woman screaming.

Near the diner door, a woman stares at the men with their guns drawn, her scream distracted them both. Arthur takes the opportunity to quickly jump into the bel air and hot-wires it within 12 seconds. The engine starts and the radio goes full blast into a rock song as Arthur slams the gas and gets the attention of the men who raise their guns toward the car. But Arthur hastily and sloppily pulls out of the space and heads toward the main road before they can fire. The men put their guns away and quickly hop into a black land cruiser to chase after him.

Arthur turns the radio off. He's far from the smoothest driver, but has put some real distance between him and his pursuers and is speeding through downtown and weaving through traffic. The radio pops back on, which startles Arthur, and he slams it off again. He sees a sign "to highway entrance ramp, 1 mile" and stays as far left as he can.

The land cruiser is getting closer, engine roaring, they pull up to Arthurs left and are about to ram him when Arthur suddenly goes right and crosses every lane, barely making it to the exit ramp and drives out onto the highway.

ARTHUR
(smiling)
Yes! Ha!

Arthur speeds down the highway, having gotten away for now.

In the backseat of the bel air, a lump of blankets roll and fall with a soft thud on the floor. From them, emerges ASPEN SIPE, a young woman in her 20s with deep red hair and wearing the same diner outfit as the waitress. Having just woken up, she looks around unable to fully open her eyes, but is slowly waking up

ASPEN
(inaudible, mouthing the
words)
m.. moving?

She slowly sits up higher, and continues to look around, Arthur can now see her in the rear view mirror. His smile immediately vanishes and a mild panic sets in.

Aspen keeps getting more and more alert, until finally locking eyes with Arthur through the mirror and they both stare for a moment.

ARTHUR
Uh, hi!--

But he's cut off by aspen screaming and quickly falling back into the seat as she kicks and hits him with her pillow.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
(blocking her hits)
He-hey! Cut it out!

She doesn't cut it out and hits Arthur a couple more times, but then stops

ASPEN
Who are you? Get out of my car!

ARTHUR
My name is Arthur, I'm kinda in a situation here, I'm sorry i didn't mean too,... kidnap you,.

ASPEN
Well, you did! Now stop!

ARTHUR
You see I--

In the rear view mirror, Red and Blue lights begins to flash, the police are here.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
(under his breath)
Oh just perfect,

Aspen notices and turns around, then taps on the rear window and waves to get the officers attention before sticking her head out the window and waving her arms.

ASPEN
Help!! I'm being kidnapped by a
crazy person!

ARTHUR
What are you doing?? Calm down!

ASPEN
Pull over!

Aspen continues to hit Arthur with miscellaneous objects around the car, throwing whatever she can reach at him.

ARTHUR	ASPEN (CONT'D)
Quit it! Do you want us to crash?	Stop you lunatic!

Aspen grabs the cardboard box from the passenger seat to throw at Arthur, but stops to inspect it instead.

ASPEN (CONT'D)
(muttering)
What the, what is this?

Arthur was on edge before, but especially now/

ARTHUR
Hey! Put that down! You don't want
to mess with that--

As if things couldn't get any worse, up ahead in the distance was the black land cruiser, driving the opposite direction down the highway toward the bel air

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
Ok, how did they even get over
there!

Aspen is lost in a trance just holding the box, and slowly moves to open it.

ASPEN
(whispering to herself)
It feels,.. familiar,

ARTHUR
Hey! Don't open that!--

He looks her in the eye and immediately gets concerned

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

Are you ok?

A beat, then BANG the driver side mirror is gone, the land cruiser is getting closer and shooting at them. Arthur snaps back and tenses, Aspen doesn't react at all.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

Jesus! What's with these guys?

Aspen fully opens the box, and looks at the pitch black void contained within, staring for a bit before looking back up toward Arthur.

ASPEN

What is it?

ARTHUR

Listen to me, I can explain everything I just need you to put that down, It's dangerous and--

BANG! Another shot shatters the rear driver side window, both Aspen and Arthur react this time.

ASPEN

Who are THEY?

ARTHUR

A real pain is who! Now give me the box!

Arthur reaches over to grab it, but aspen won't let go.

ASPEN

No! Let go!

ARTHUR

You let go!

Another Bang, the front tire is out, and police backup are on their way behind them as well. The bel air jerks, turning the radio on again, blasting Somebody to Love by Jefferson Airplane into the cabin.

Arthur just manages to keep control of the vehicle as Aspen and the box are flung over the seat to upfront.

Arthur grabbed the box, and looked inside, but it was empty. He immediately started looking around the car

ARTHUR (CONT'D)

Don't move! Be very careful,. Where is it,.

Aspen manages to sit upright and starts looking around with Arthur.

ASPEN
What are we looking for?

ARTHUR
The black rock,.

Aspen looks at her hands, and holds them up for Arthur to see.

ASPEN
Oh, I've got it, don't worry!

Arthur looks at her with great surprise as she's holding up the stone.

ARTHUR
What the--

Before Arthur can finish his thought, the black land cruiser appears on the passenger side, and rams the bel air sending it into a spin. The centrifugal force sends Aspen sliding across the seat directly into Arthur, and the moment they touch, everything goes dark.

EXT. GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The bel air continues to spin for a minute, but eventually comes to a stop. The radio is now nothing but static, and the 2 passengers just sit there for a minute next to each other breathing and calming down. It's dark outside, and the highway asphalt is now a grass field.

A beat. Arthur needs a moment to catch his breath, Aspen is simply in shock, staring out the windshield at the new environment. The world brightens slightly as an overhead street lamp flickers on.

Aspen awkwardly stumbles out of the car, and almost falls over but catches herself on the door. She takes a second to regain her balance and takes a few staggered steps away. Arthur notices and quickly gets out as well.

ARTHUR
Hey! Where are you going?

Aspen doesn't respond, just takes a couple more steps. Arthur walks after her

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
Listen, we need to--

Aspen turns around and interrupts, shushing him. Eyes closed, she takes a breath and recomposes herself, then opens them and stares at Arthur.

ASPEN
(exasperated)
WHAT'S GOING ON??

She has a stressed but determined expression, and stares him down even more. Arthur holds up his hands slightly like a lion tamer, and speaks calmly.

ARTHUR
We've traveled. Now I don't know where but, we're in a dangerous situation.

ASPEN
WE are in a dangerous situation?
You KIDNAPPED me! I'M the one in a dangerous situation!

ARTHUR
I didn't know you were back there!
I'm not happy with this situation either!

ASPEN
Ok then, take me home!

ARTHUR
I will!

A beat.

ARTHUR (CONT'D)
I will... soon. I can't yet-

Aspen throws her head back and laughs.

ASPEN
Ha! I knew it. You kidnapped me.
You know my ransom isn't worth a lot right?

ARTHUR
I don't know who id even contact for your ransom. Look, jumping is dangerous, and it takes tons of concentration to work properly or you'll end up in another time and--

ASPEN
Another time?

Aspen stares in disbelief. Arthur places his hands on his hips and sighs.

ARTHUR
Yes. Another time.

Aspens shock shifts again to a smile, and she's laughing once again.

ASPEN
Oh man, you really ARE crazy! I mean, I figured already,

Aspen gestures to all of him.

ASPEN (CONT'D)
But I mean REALLY crazy. Like, genuinely.

Arthur rubs his temples, and drags his hand down his face, then claps once.

ARTHUR
Ok! Do you want to go home?

ASPEN
What do you think??

ARTHUR
Ok, then i need you to trust me.

Now it's Aspens turn to bury her head in her hands, and begins pacing.

ASPEN
(whispering to herself)
This isn't happening, this isn't happening,.

Arthur is watching her go back and forth.

ARTHUR
We just need to grab the rock and-

His expression changes suddenly, and is now more alert. He darts his head around scanning the area. He finds the rock on the grass 30 feet from where they're standing, and walks over, taking off his jacket. Aspen notices and is broken from her pace, then she decides to follow.

Arthur bends down, and wraps his jacket around the rock, careful as last time. He stands up slowly, holding it secure. Aspen stares and cocks her head slightly at the rock for a beat.

ASPEN

What is it?

Arthur looks just past her, and now visible is a small row of buildings and a road. One with a sign that reads "24 hour coffee".

ARTHUR

Do you want some coffee?

INT. COFFEE SHOP - CONTINUOUS